



Trailhead



[Database & .NET Basics \(/content/learn/modules/database_basics_dotnet?trailmix_creator_id=srebello7&trailmix_slug=salesforce-platform-developer\)](/content/learn/modules/database_basics_dotnet?trailmix_creator_id=srebello7&trailmix_slug=salesforce-platform-developer)



Modify Records with DML

Modify Records with DML

Learning Objectives

After completing this unit, you'll:

- Understand how to use the Query Grid in Developer Console to manipulate data records directly.
- Understand how to use DML to persist data to the database.
- Be able to identify two ways to write DML commands.

Manage Data in Developer Console

So far we've seen how to use Developer Console to query data using SOQL and SOSL. What you probably didn't notice was that the Query Results pane displayed in Developer Console not only displays the results, but it functions as a query grid. You can click in the results grid and use the buttons below the grid to insert, update, or delete data.

Let's give it a try.

1. From the Setup menu, select **Developer Console**.
2. Click the **Query Editor**.
3. Delete any existing code, and insert the following query:

```
SELECT Id, Name, Industry FROM Account
```



4. Click **Execute**.

The query results displays all accounts in the org, along with a count of the total rows. Notice what this value is.

5. Click **Insert Row**.

A new row is added at the top of the grid.

6. Double-click in the new row to enter a name and industry, but leave the ID value blank.



7. Click **Save Rows**.

Notice that a value is automatically displayed in the Id column. Remember, the ID is



As developers, we know that you sometimes have the need to manage data on the fly and we wanted to make it as easy for you as possible. We think it sure beats typing in an [INSERT, UPDATE, or DELETE statement](https://content.force.com/learn/modules/database_basics_dotnet?trailmix_creator_id=srebello7&trailmix_slug=salesforce-platform-developer) ([Database & .NET Basics \(/content/learn/modules/database_basics_dotnet?trailmix_creator_id=srebello7&trailmix_slug=salesforce-platform-developer\)](https://content.force.com/learn/modules/database_basics_dotnet?trailmix_creator_id=srebello7&trailmix_slug=salesforce-platform-developer)).

Modify Records with DML You can also use the buttons at the bottom right of the query results to access the records in Salesforce directly. Go ahead and give it a try.

What Is DML?

As you learned in the first unit, Salesforce uses SOQL to query data, but when it comes to managing the data, DML is used instead.

As a .NET developer, you primarily use SQL to query and manage data, so it could feel strange to use another language. But we think you'll find working with the DML commands in Salesforce much easier than the SQL equivalents.

Because Salesforce is so tightly integrated, you can get straight to the business of manipulating your data without worrying about managing a data source. That's one reason why DML is so easy to work with.

DML Statements

Check out the table below to see which DML statements are available. Some probably look familiar to you, and they work pretty much as you would expect them to. See the [Developer's Guide \(https://developer.salesforce.com/docs/atlas.en-us.apexref.meta/apexref/apex_dml_section.htm\)](https://developer.salesforce.com/docs/atlas.en-us.apexref.meta/apexref/apex_dml_section.htm) for more information.

Statement	Description
insert	Inserts a new record.
update	Updates an existing record.



a single statement. It uses a specified field to determine the presence of existing objects, or the ID field if no field is specified.

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delete	Deletes an existing record.
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undelete	Restores one or more existing records from the recycle bin.
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merge	This is another special operation that can merge up to three records of the same object type into one of the records. It will then delete the other records and reparent any related records.
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Two Ways to Execute DML

In Apex, you can execute DML statements in two ways.

- **Using the statement itself:** You've already seen this method in the unit on SOSL in which we inserted Account and Contact data. This method is the easiest way. In case you don't remember, here is some code from the SOSL unit. A single Account was inserted using the insert DML statement.

```

1 // Add Account
2 Account acct = new Account(
3     Name='Test Account',
4     Phone='(225) 555-8989',
5     NumberOfEmployees=10,
6     BillingCity='Baton Rouge'
7 );
8 insert acct;
```



- **Using Database class methods:** The advantage of using the Database class method is that you have access to the optional `allOrNone`  parameter to specify whether the operation can partially succeed. When this parameter is set to false, if an error occurs on a partial set of records, the successful records are committed. Errors for the failed records are returned. Also, no exceptions are thrown with the partial success option. For example, to create an Account with the `allOrNone` 



```
3      Name='Test Account',
4      Phone=' (225) 555-8989',
5      NumberOfEmployees=10,
6      BillingCity='Baton Rouge',
7  );
8  Database.SaveResult[] results = Database.insert(acct,
9      false);
```

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Modify Records with DML.

Tell Me More

By default, the allOrNone parameter is true, which means that the Database method behaves like its DML counterpart and throws an exception if a failure is encountered. Check out the [official docs \(https://developer.salesforce.com/docs/atlas.en-us.apexcode.meta/apexcode/langCon_apex_dml_database.htm\)](https://developer.salesforce.com/docs/atlas.en-us.apexcode.meta/apexcode/langCon_apex_dml_database.htm) for more information.

If you want to become a DML rockstar, complete the [Apex Basics & Database \(https://trailhead.salesforce.com/content/learn/modules/apex_database\)](https://trailhead.salesforce.com/content/learn/modules/apex_database) module. It contains more information about how to insert records with partial success and how to insert related records.

Resources

- [Salesforce Help: Query Results Grid \(https://help.salesforce.com/s/articleView?id=platform.code_dev_console_tab_query_editor_query_results_grid.htm&type=5\)](https://help.salesforce.com/s/articleView?id=platform.code_dev_console_tab_query_editor_query_results_grid.htm&type=5)

Quiz

To complete this unit, you need to answer all the quiz questions correctly.

+100 Points

1 Which of the following is NOT a valid DML statement?

A

upsert



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E undelete

2 The main difference between DML statements and database methods are:

- A** DML statements are typically faster for indexed operations.
- B** DML statements return an array of results for each record for success or failure.
- C** Database methods allow you to specify to not throw errors.
- D** Database methods allow you to specify whether the operation can partially succeed.

Second attempt earns 50 points. Three or more earns 25 points.

Check the Quiz to Earn 100 Points

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